mechanisms to protect your API, and these will be implemented as filters within the `Main` class without altering the controller objects. This is a common pattern when developing REST APIs and makes the code a bit easier to read as the HTTP-specific details are separated from the core logic of the API. While you can write secure code without implementing this separation, it is much easier to review security mechanisms if they are clearly separated rather than mixed into the core logic.

> **DEFINITION** A ***controller*** is a piece of code in your API that responds to requests from users. The term comes from the popular model-view-controller (MVC) pattern for constructing user interfaces. The model is a structured view of data relevant to a request, while the view is the user interface that displays that data to the user. The controller then processes requests made by the user and updates the model appropriately. In a typical REST API, there is no view component beyond simple JSON formatting, but it is still useful to structure your code in terms of controller objects.

2.2.1 Creating a new space

The first operation you'll implement is to allow a user to create a new social space, which they can then claim as owner, as shown in listing 2.4 below. You'll create a new `SpaceController` class that will handle all operations related to creating and interacting with social spaces. The controller will be initialized with the Dalesbred `Database` object that you created in listing 2.3. The `createSpace` method will be called